## Helpless Sulṭān Husayn

All of a sudden, out of nowhere, Babur received letters from Sulṭān Husayn Mīrzā spelling out wrong and far-fetched intentions. He wrote similar letters to Badī'u'z-Zamān Mīrzā, Khusrau Shāh and Ẕū'n-nūn Beg. His purpose was very clear. According to Babur, the contents were as follows:[*]

> When the three brothers, Sulṭān Maḥmūd Mīrzā, Sulṭān Aḥmad Mīrzā, and Aūlūgh Beg Mīrzā, joined together and advanced against me, I defended the bank of the Murgh-āb in such a way that they retired without being able to affect anything. Now if the Aūzbegs advance, I might myself guard the bank of the Murgh-āb again; let Badī'u'z-zamān Mīrzā leave men to defend the forts of Balkh, Shibarghān, and Andikhūd while he himself guards Girzawān, the Zang-valley, and the hill-country thereabouts.

Having heard of Babur living in that vicinity, he wrote:[*]

> Do you make fast Kāhmard, Ajar and that hill-tract; let Khusrau Shāh place trusty men in Ḥiṣār and Qūndūz; let his younger brother Walī make fast Badakhshān and the Khutlān hills; then the Aūzbeg will retire, able to do nothing.

The letters of Sulṭān Husayn left Babur in despair. He could never think in his dreams of the helplessness of Husayn. Babur expressed his thoughts on the situation:[†]

> There was in Tīmūr Beg's territory (yūrt) no ruler so great as Sulṭān Ḥusain Mīrzā, whether by his years, armed strength, or dominions; it was to be expected, therefore, that envoys would go, treading on each other's heels, with clear and sharp orders, such as, 'Arrange for so many boats at the Tīrmīz, Kilīf, and Kīrkī ferries,' 'Get any quantity of bridge material together,' and 'Well watch the ferries above Tūqūz-aūlūm,' so that men whose spirit years of Aūzbeg oppression had broken, might be cheered to hope again. But how could hope live in tribe or horde when a great ruler like Sulṭān Ḥusayn Mīrzā, sitting in the place of Tīmūr Beg, spoke, not of marching forth to meet the enemy, but only of defense against his attack?

Babur moved out of Ajar with all his men.

## Babur's Strength Begins to Grow

Babur's fortune had started to shine. Various Moghūls of Khusrau Shāh kept coming to Babur, increasing his hope and strength with each passing day. They said, 'We of the Moghūl horde, desiring the royal welfare, have drawn off from ṭāīkhān towards Ishkīmīsh and Fūlūl. Let the Padishah advance as fast as